

FinOps Intelligence Dashboard Project

Lessons Learned · v1.0 · June 2026 · Prepared by: Anumeha Princy, PMP® — Operations PM

Project ID: FIDP-2025-001 | Data Period: January–May 2025 | Company: Monitri (Simulated BaaS Environment)

Technical Challenges & Fixes

Challenge	Fix Applied	Lesson
Column names with % symbol caused SQL syntax errors	Renamed columns in DB Browser — removed % symbol. New names: contracted_uptime, actual_uptime	Always use alphanumeric column names with underscores only. Special characters cause persistent issues across all SQL tools.
Uptime values stored as text with % symbol — math operations returned 0	Used REPLACE + CAST to strip symbol and convert to REAL before aggregation	Numeric data should never be stored with units or symbols. If it must be, REPLACE + CAST is the SQLite solution.
Month values stored as text — sorted alphabetically not chronologically (Apr before Feb)	Documented as known limitation. Recommended ISO format (YYYY-MM) for future builds.	Store dates as DATE type or ISO format for reliable chronological sorting. Text month labels are display-friendly but not sort-friendly.
CSV import in DB Browser defaulted to wrong table name and missing headers	Manually corrected table name and checked 'Column names in first line' before confirming import	Always verify table name and header settings before confirming CSV import. Wrong table name creates a duplicate table.
JOIN query returning duplicate rows — Q22 returned 9 rows instead of 3	Added SELECT DISTINCT to remove duplicates caused by one-to-many JOIN matches	When JOINing tables with one-to-many relationships, always check result row count. Use SELECT DISTINCT if it exceeds expected output.
Financial data stored with \$ and comma — SUM and AVG failed	Double REPLACE to strip both symbols: CAST(REPLACE(REPLACE(col,'\$',','),',','') AS REAL)	Store financial data as numeric — display formatting is separate. Cleaning at query time is a workaround, not a solution.
Resolution_Time stored as text with unit — AVG returned 0	CAST(REPLACE(Resolution_Time, 'hours', '') AS REAL) — stripped unit before converting to REAL	Store duration as numeric integers. Text units require cleanup at query time and cause silent failures in aggregations.

PM Lessons

- **Detection time improved 92%** — from 3-4 days manual to 15 minutes via FIDP dashboard. Real-time data visibility changes the speed of every downstream decision. This single metric is the clearest proof of FIDP's operational value.
- **Vendor risk requires dual-track analysis** — Stripe was failing as a vendor AND as a CI/CD root cause simultaneously. Single-metric analysis would have missed the systemic exposure. Cross-query pattern recognition is what FIDP was built for.
- **Proof artifacts are not optional** — every PM action claim must be backed by a document. Without proof, a finding is just an opinion. Every Jira comment in this project is backed by a specific document or dataset record.
- **Pattern recognition beats incident management** — 7 escalated anomalies all linked to CI/CD pipeline failures. Seeing the pattern early allows structural fixes, not repeated patches. The anomaly query didn't just show 7 issues — it showed one root cause.
- **Scope discipline matters** — Jumio termination was a major scope addition managed through formal change control (CHG006). Without the change log, this decision would have been invisible to stakeholders and the project record.

What I Would Do Differently

- Store all date fields as ISO format (YYYY-MM-DD) from the start — text month labels caused sorting issues throughout the project and required workarounds in multiple queries.

- Add a numeric Cost_USD_Clean column at data build time — cleaning financial data at query time across SQL and Looker Studio is inefficient and error-prone.
- Build the deployment readiness checklist before the first incident — not after analyzing 16 failures. A pre-deployment governance tool should be a project input, not an output.